# InterpWhat: Go-To-Market, Partner, and Sales Strategy

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## 1. Go-To-Market (GTM) Strategy: A Phased Approach

Our GTM strategy is designed to build momentum, validate product-market fit, and scale efficiently. We will execute in three distinct phases over the first 18 months.

### Phase 1: Foundation & Community (Months 1-3)

- **Objective:** Acquire our first 1,000 users and 100 paying customers.
- **Focus:** Organic growth, community building, and content marketing.
- **Key Activities:**
    - **Content Marketing:** Launch a blog and social media channels focused on high-value educational content (e.g., "5 Signs Your Dog is Secretly Stressed," "How to Introduce a New Cat to Your Home").
    - **Community Engagement:** Actively participate in pet-related subreddits (r/dogs, r/cats, r/PetAdvice), Facebook groups, and pet forums. Offer free behavior reports and answer questions to build trust and authority.
    - **Leverage Founder Story:** Share Chantell and Paisley's story to create an emotional connection with our audience.
    - **Black Friday Launch:** Execute a high-impact Black Friday campaign to drive initial subscriptions.

### Phase 2: Acceleration & Partnerships (Months 4-12)

- **Objective:** Scale to 5,000 paying customers and 50 shelter partners.
- **Focus:** Expanding our reach through partnerships and targeted outreach.
- **Key Activities:**

    - **Affiliate Program Launch:** Onboard our first 20 affiliate partners (influencers, bloggers, local businesses).
    - **Shelter Outreach:** Systematically reach out to our target list of 200+ no-kill shelters.
    - **PR & Media:** Pitch our story to pet and tech publications.
    - **Paid Social (Initial Tests):** Begin small-scale, targeted ad campaigns on Facebook and Instagram to test messaging and CAC.

### Phase 3: Scaling & Optimization (Months 13-18)

- **Objective:** Reach 10,000 paying customers and 100 shelter partners.
- **Focus:** Optimizing conversion funnels and scaling what works.
- **Key Activities:**
    - **Scale Paid Acquisition:** Increase ad spend based on successful tests.
    - **SEO Optimization:** Double down on content that ranks for high-intent keywords.
    - **Partnership Expansion:** Target larger national brands and pet insurance companies.
    - **Conversion Rate Optimization (CRO):** A/B test landing pages, pricing, and onboarding flows.

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## 2. Partner Strategy: A Three-Pillar Approach

Our partner strategy is designed to create a powerful, multi-channel distribution network.

### Pillar 1: Shelter Partnerships (B2B2C)

- **Value Proposition:** We help shelters reduce animal stress, improve adoption matching, lower return rates, and enhance their public image as a data-driven, welfare-focused organization.
- **Business Model:**
    - **Shelter Subscription:** $33/mo for unlimited staff access and analytics.

    - **Revenue Share:** Shelters receive a **10% lifetime commission** on every adopter they refer to our "Rescue Hero" plan.
- **Sales Cycle:**
    1. **Outreach:** Personalized emails to shelter directors.
    2. **Demo:** A 30-minute demo showcasing the platform's value.
    3. **Onboarding:** A simple, 1-hour onboarding session for shelter staff.

### Pillar 2: Affiliate Program (Influencers & Bloggers)

- **Value Proposition:** We offer a generous commission and a high-quality product that their audience will love.
- **Commission Structure: 25% recurring commission** for 12 months on all referred subscriptions.
- **Target Affiliates:**
    - Pet influencers on Instagram and TikTok (10k-100k followers).
    - Pet bloggers with established SEO authority.
    - Niche content creators (e.g., dog trainers, cat behaviorists).

### Pillar 3: Strategic Partnerships (Businesses)

- **Value Proposition:** We provide a value-add service for their customers and a new revenue stream.
- **Target Partners:**
    - **Pet Insurance Companies:** Offer InterpWhat as a preventative wellness tool to reduce claims.
    - **Veterinary Clinics:** Position InterpWhat as a between-visit monitoring tool.
    - **Pet Food Brands:** Co-marketing campaigns and bundle deals.

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## 3. Sales Strategy: A Lean, Founder-Led Approach

For the first 18 months, our sales efforts will be founder-led, focusing on high-leverage activities.

- **Team:** Chantell will lead shelter and affiliate outreach, leveraging her passion and story. Her co-founder will support with technical demos and sales operations.
- **Process (Shelters):**
    1. **Qualify:** Identify high-potential shelters from our target list.
    2. **Personalize:** Research each shelter and tailor the outreach email.
    3. **Demo:** Use a standardized demo script to ensure consistency.
    4. **Close:** A simple, one-page agreement.
    5. **Onboard:** A hands-on onboarding process to ensure success.
- **Tools:**
    - **CRM:** A simple CRM (like HubSpot Free or a spreadsheet) to track our pipeline.
    - **Email Automation:** A tool like Resend or Mailchimp for outreach sequences.
    - **Calendly:** For scheduling demos.

**We will not hire a dedicated sales team until we have achieved product-market fit and have a repeatable sales playbook.** Our focus is on building genuine relationships and proving the model, not on scaling a sales force prematurely.